

Amharic Typing Games, full guide

A Practical Guide to typing in Amharic

Getting Started with Keyman

1. How the Keyboard Works
2. The Four Typing Rules
3. Complete Letter Reference
4. Rounded-Lip Letters
5. Ethiopic Numbers
6. Punctuation
7. Quick Reference

Keyman: A Required Component

Why Keyman?

Amharic Typing Games uses Keyman to enable Amharic text input on your device. Without it, the app cannot convert your keystrokes into Amharic (Ethiopic) script.

Already installed?

Most likely yes! When you installed Amharic Typing Games, Keyman and the Amharic keyboard package should have been set up automatically alongside the app.

What to do next

Step 1: Check if Keyman is installed (see next slide)

Step 2: If missing, install Keyman with the Amharic keyboard package (instructions on the following slide)

Step 3: Return to Amharic Typing Games and start playing!

Tip: If Keyman was already present when you first launched the app, you're all set — go straight to the verification step.

Getting Started with Keyman

Keyman is a free input method manager that lets you type Amharic on any standard keyboard. The Amharic Typing Game's app should have installed it automatically.

How to Check if Keyman is Installed

Operating System	Where to Look	What You Should See
Windows	System tray (bottom-right corner of taskbar)	A "K" icon in the notification area. Click it to see active keyboards.
macOS	Menu bar (top-right of screen)	A flag or language icon. Open System Settings > Keyboard > Input Sources and look for "Amharic (Keyman)".
Linux	Input method panel or terminal	Run: <code>keyman --version</code> in a terminal. A version number confirms it is installed.
Any	Open any text editor	Switch to the Amharic keyboard and type "se" — you should see ሰ appear.

 **Tip:** If you saw an installation prompt when you first launched the app, Keyman is likely already set up. Skip straight to the verification step.

Installing Keyman

If Keyman is not already installed, follow these steps:

Step	Action
1	Visit keyman.com in your web browser and click Download Keyman. The site detects your operating system automatically.
2	Run the installer and follow the on-screen prompts. On Windows and macOS you may need to grant administrator permission.
3	After installation, open Keyman Configuration (from the system tray or menu bar icon). Go to Keyboard Layouts and search for Amharic.
4	Click Install next to the Amharic keyboard package, then confirm. Keyman will download and activate it.
5	Restart the Amharic Typing Game's app. Your keyboard is now ready — type selam and watch ሰላም appear!

Still not working? Make sure you have selected the Amharic keyboard in Keyman before typing. Click the Keyman icon and select Amharic. On some systems you may need to log out and back in after first installation.

1. How the Keyman Amharic Keyboard Works

The Keyman Amharic keyboard uses a phonetic system — you type the sounds of Amharic words using English letters, and the keyboard converts them into the correct Amharic (Ethiopic) script.

selam → ሰላም *Hello / Peace*

The Seven Orders — Example with letter M:

Order	Name	Vowel sound	Type	Result
1st	ግዕዝ	–e– (like "men")	me	መ
2nd	ካዕብ	–u– (like "moon")	mu	ሙ
3rd	ሣልስ	–i– (like "meet")	mi	ሚ
4th	ራብዕ	–a– (like "ma")	ma	ማ
5th	ኃምስ	–ie– (like "meh")	mie	ሚኔ
6th	ሳድስ	no vowel (neutral)	m	ም
7th	ሳብዕ	–o– (like "more")	mo	ሞ

Tip: The 6th order is typed with the consonant alone — no vowel. m = ም s = ሰ b = ብ

2. The Four Typing Rules (Rules 1 & 2)

Rule 1 — Capital Letters for Emphatic Sounds

Some Amharic sounds are stronger versions of English sounds. For these, type the CAPITAL (uppercase) letter.

Type	Result	Notes
Te	ፒ	Emphatic T — 1st order
Tu / Ti / Ta	ፓ / ፔ / ፕ	Other orders
T	ፒ	6th order (no vowel)
TienaysTlN	ፒናይስፒልኝ	"How are you?" (informal)

Rule 2 — Double Letters for Rare Sounds

For sounds that are more distinct, type the same key twice. If the capital doesn't give what you want, try doubling it.

Type	Result	Notes
se	ሰ	Regular S
sse	ሠ	Rare S (older letter)
SSe	ፀ	Double-capital (e.g., ፀሐይ — Sun: SSeHey)

2. The Four Typing Rules (Rules 3 & 4)

Rule 3 — Extra Vowel After u for Rounded-Lip Letters

Some Amharic letters are pronounced with rounded lips (like w). Type: consonant + u + extra vowel.

Type	Result	Breakdown
mua	ሚ	M + rounded lips + A
gua	ጒ	G + rounded lips + A
guie	ጒይ	G + rounded lips + IE
kua	ኳ	K + rounded lips + A

Rule 4 — Apostrophe to Separate 6th-Order + Vowel

Normally typing a vowel after a consonant creates a combined letter. To keep a bare consonant and a separate vowel apart, insert an apostrophe (') between them.

Type	Result	Meaning
gebr'iel	ገብርኤል	"Gabriel"
m'eeraf	ምዕራፍ	"Chapter / West"
mel'ak	መልአክ	"Angel"
k' '	ከ'	Literal apostrophe — type " (double apostrophe)

3. Complete Letter Reference (1/7)

ሆይ (h)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ሀ	ሁ	ሂ	ሃ	ሄ	ህ	ሆ
he	hu	hi	ha	hie	h	ho

ላዊ (l)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ለ	ሉ	ሊ	ላ	ሌ	ል	ሎ
le	lu	li	la	lie	l	lo

ሐውት (H)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ሐ	ሁ	ሂ	ሃ	ሄ	ህ	ሆ
He	Hu	Hi	Ha	Hie	H	Ho

ማይ (m)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
መ	ሙ	ሚ	ማ	ሜ	ም	ሞ
me	mu	mi	ma	mie	m	mo

3. Complete Letter Reference (2/7)

ርእስ (r)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ረ	ሩ	ሪ	ራ	ሪ	ር	ሮ
re	ru	ri	ra	rie	r	ro

ሳት (s)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ሰ	ሱ	ሲ	ሳ	ሴ	ስ	ሶ
se	su	si	sa	sie	s	so

ኧ-ሳት (x)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ኧ	ኧ	ኧ	ኧ	ኧ	ኧ	ኧ
xe	xu	xi	xa	xie	x	xo

ቃፍ (q)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ቃ	ቃ	ቃ	ቃ	ቃ	ቃ	ቃ
qe	qu	qi	qa	qie	q	qo

3. Complete Letter Reference (3/7)

ቬ-ቤት (v)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ቬ	ቬ	ቬ	ቬ	ቬ	ቬ	ቬ
ve	vu	vi	va	vie	v	vo

ታው (t)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ታ	ታ	ታ	ታ	ታ	ታ	ታ
te	tu	ti	ta	tie	t	to

ቻ-ታው (c)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ቻ	ቻ	ቻ	ቻ	ቻ	ቻ	ቻ
ce	cu	ci	ca	cie	c	co

ካርም (hh)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ካ	ካ	ካ	ካ	ካ	ካ	ካ
hhe	hhu	hhi	hha	hhie	hh	hho

3. Complete Letter Reference (4/7)

ኛ-ነሐስ (N)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ኛ	ኛ	ኛ	ኛ	ኛ	ኛ	ኛ
Ne	Nu	Ni	Na	Nie	N	No

አልፍ (a)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
አ	አ	አ	አ	አ	አ	አ
a	u	i	aaaa	ie	e	o

ካፍ (k)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ካ	ካ	ካ	ካ	ካ	ካ	ካ
ke	ku	ki	ka	kie	k	ko

ኸ-ካፍ (K)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ኸ	ኸ	ኸ	ኸ	ኸ	ኸ	ኸ
Ke	Ku	Ki	Ka	Kie	K	Ko

3. Complete Letter Reference (5/7)

0ᄇᄃ (aa)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
0	0ᄃ	ᄃ	ᄃ	ᄃ	ᄃ	ᄃ
aaa	uu	ii	aa	iie	ee	oo

ᄃᄃ (z)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ᄃ	ᄃᄃ	ᄃ	ᄃ	ᄃ	ᄃ	ᄃ
ze	zu	zi	za	zie	z	zo

ᄃᄃᄃ (Z)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ
Ze	Zu	Zi	Za	Zie	Z	Zo

ᄃᄃᄃ (y)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ	ᄃᄃ
ye	yu	yi	ya	yie	y	yo

3. Complete Letter Reference (6/7)

ጅ-ድገት (j)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ጅ	ጆ	ጇ	ገ	ገጅ	ገጅ	ገጅ
je	ju	ji	ja	jie	j	jo

ገምል (g)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ገ	ገ	ገ	ገ	ገ	ገ	ገ
ge	gu	gi	ga	gie	g	go

ጠይት (T)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ጠ	ጠ	ጠ	ጠ	ጠ	ጠ	ጠ
Te	Tu	Ti	Ta	Tie	T	To

ጨ-ጠይት (C)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ጨ	ጨ	ጨ	ጨ	ጨ	ጨ	ጨ
Ce	Cu	Ci	Ca	Cie	C	Co

3. Complete Letter Reference (7/7)

ᐱᐱᐱ (S)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ᐱ	ᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
Se	Su	Si	Sa	Sie	S	So

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ (SS)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
SSe	SSu	SSi	SSa	SSie	SS	SSo

ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ (f)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
fe	fu	fi	fa	fie	f	fo

ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ (p)

1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
pe	pu	pi	pa	pie	p	po

4. Rounded-Lip (Labialized) Letters

Type: consonant + u + extra vowel

Type	Result	Type	Result	Type	Result
Hua	ᠬᠤᠠ	mua	ᠮᠤᠠ	rua	ᠷᠤᠠ
sua	ᠰᠤᠠ	que	ᠬᠤᠡ	qua	ᠬᠤᠠ
bua	ᠪᠤᠠ	cua	ᠴᠤᠠ	hue	ᠬᠤᠡ
hua	ᠬᠤᠠ	nua	ᠨᠤᠠ	Nua	ᠨᠤᠠ
kue	ᠬᠤᠡ	kua	ᠬᠤᠠ	gua	ᠭᠤᠠ
guie	ᠭᠤᠡ	Tua	ᠲᠤᠠ	Cua	ᠴᠤᠠ
Pua	ᠫᠤᠠ	Sua	ᠰᠤᠠ	fua	ᠫᠤᠠ
pua	ᠫᠤᠠ				

5. Ethiopic Numbers

Type a hash mark (#) followed by the Arabic number:

Type	Result	Meaning
#1	፩	One
#10	፲	Ten
#100	፲፱	One hundred
#10000	፻፹፱	Ten thousand

Full Number Reference:

#1	#2	#3	#4	#5	#6	#7	#8	#9
፩	፪	፫	፬	፭	፮	፯	፰	፱
#10	#20	#30	#40	#50	#60	#70	#80	#90
፲	፳	፴	፵	፶	፷	፸	፹	፺
#100	#1000	#10000						
፲፱	፲፻	፲፱፻						

Note: To type a literal # before a number, type ## (double hash).

6. Punctuation

Ethiopic punctuation is produced by typing the similar key twice (or more). All standard English punctuation works normally.

Symbol	Type	Meaning
፡	:	Word separator (classical texts)
።	::	Full stop — end of sentence
፣	,	Comma — pause within a sentence
፤	;	Semicolon — stronger pause
፦	:—	Introduces a list or quote
፪	, ,	Double comma — paragraph mark
፬	:+	Section mark
፮	:#	Book / passage mark
‹	<	Single left quotation mark
›	>	Single right quotation mark
«	<<	Double left quotation mark
»	>>	Double right quotation mark

7. Quick Reference

Situation	What to do	Examples
Normal letter	consonant + vowel	se=ሰ ma=ማ bo=ቦ
6th order (no vowel)	consonant only	m=ም s=ሰ b=ቦ
Emphatic/strong sound	Use CAPITAL letter	Te=ጢ Ce=፫ Pe=፳
Rare similar-sounding letter	Double the lowercase key	sse=ሥ SSe=፬
Rounded-lip letter	consonant + u + extra vowel	mua=ሚ gua=ጓ
Bare consonant + vowel	Insert apostrophe ' between	gebr'iel=ገብርኤል
Literal apostrophe	Type " (double apostrophe)	k' '= '
Ethiopic numeral	# + number	#1=፩ #10=፲ #100=፷
Literal # before number	Type ## (double hash)	##=#
Ethiopic punctuation	Type similar key twice+	::.= := ,= <<=«